

issues that meet the requirements. Once the team has created the required network configuration changes to implement the security policy, you can apply these to any future configuration changes. While it's possible for the security team to review all changes, this process allows them to only review changes that pose enough risk to warrant special treatment.

We recommend that the security team review the following types of changes:

- Any change to the firewall configuration
- Any change to access control lists (ACL)
- Any change to Simple Network Management Protocol (SNMP) configuration
- Any change or update in software that differs from the approved software revision level list

It's also recommended to adhere to the following guidelines:

- Change passwords to network devices on a routine basis
- Restrict access to network devices to an approved list of personnel
- Ensure that the current software revision levels of network equipment and server environments are in compliance with the security configuration requirements

In addition to these approval guidelines, have a representative from the security team sit on the change management approval board, in order to monitor all changes that the board reviews. The security team representative can deny any change that is considered a security change until it has been approved by the security team.

2. Monitoring Your Network Security

Security monitoring is similar to network monitoring, except that it focuses on detecting changes in the network that indicate a security violation. The starting point for security monitoring is determining what is a violation. In 'Conduct a Risk Analysis', we identified the level of monitoring required based on the threat to the system. In 'Approving Security Changes', we identified specific threats to the network. By looking at both these parameters, we'll develop a clear picture of what you need to monitor and how often.